

Flemish HBM Studies – User Guide

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User Guide

This user guide describes how to request and use Flemish HBM Data in a correct and responsible way.

You can navigate to detailed guidance for:

Data Users - Receiving Data Controllers

Overview

This section describes how to get access to biobanked samples and/or data of the **Flemish HBM studies**.

It focuses on:

- Submission of a **Sample and/or Data request**
-

Legal and ethical framework

Requests may involve **sensitive personal data**, including health data.

All processing must comply with applicable national and EU legal and ethical requirements.

Agreements

to provide context

- Material transfer agreement[LINK to be included]
- Controller agreement[LINK to be included]

Data and/or Sample access request

Access to **biobanked samples** and/or **individual-level data** of the **Flemish HBM studies** is granted on request and subject to approval.

Who can request access?

Sample and/or Data access requests can be submitted by stakeholders for research projects in the public interest, in line with the objectives of the Flemish HBM studies.

Data access procedure

Step-by-step

1. Submits a **Sample and/or Data Access Request Form**
 - Via **Microsoft Forms**[LINK to be included].
 - To prepare for a form submission, you may consult the corresponding word version here[LINK to be included].
 - Provides the required annexes as instructed in the form.
 - Selection of **studies**:
 - Selection of **samples**:
 - Selection of **variables**:
2. The request is reviewed by the **Flemish Supervisory Board**
3. If approved, access is granted:
 - to the requested Flemish HBM biobanked samples
 - to the requested subset of Flemish HBM data (studies and variables),
 - **only after signature of the applicable agreements**
 - Data Controller Agreement[LINK to be included]
 - Material Transfer Agreement[LINK to be included]
4. Approved samples are made available through the Biobank manager
5. Approved data extracts are made available through Flemish HBM Data Platform manager (contact)

To avoid requesting samples / data for research questions that have already been explored, it is advised to browse the Publications section in this user guide prior to submitting your request.

Annex – Studies

Download the **Annex – Studies** file(s) from Studies.

For each study you request: - set **request_stud_1isYes = 1**

All studies marked with **request_stud_1isYes = 1** are included in the request.

Annex – Samples

Download the **Annex – Samples** file(s) from Samples.

For each sample type you request: - set **request_sample_1isYes = 1**

All studies marked with **request_sample_1isYes = 1** are included in the request.

Annex – Variables

Download the **Annex – Variables** file(s) from the Codebooks

For each variable you request: - set **request_var_1isYes = 1**

All variables marked with **request_var_1isYes = 1** are included in the request.

Only annex files **generated and completed via materials provided via the Samples; Studies; and Codebooks sections of this page** are accepted.

Questions?

For questions regarding sample and/or data availability or the request procedure, please contact:
flehs.datamanagement@vito.be ****